

Journaler — a quick start

Your writing home for the term · TCE 284 · everything stays on your computer

Journaler is where you do your writing this term. It runs in your browser, and nothing you write is uploaded — it lives on **your** computer. There are five tabs across the top, in the order the course uses them: **Tips**, **Freewrite**, **Readings**, **Currere**, and **Notebook**. It opens on the day's tip, and Notebook sits at the end because that is what everything else here feeds.

The five tabs

Tips you start here

Where the app opens. One short passage a day from **Bad Ideas About Writing** — a free book of forty-three chapters, each taking apart one bad idea about writing. The rail lists every one this term; the day's is highlighted. Nothing is asked of you here, but **+ Share with notebook** opens a place to write about it and **Discuss with Romano** asks him. The book is linked on every tip and it is worth reading.

Freewrite

The five One-Pagers live here, and so do the pages for your **required notebook entries** — see below. Each One-Pager runs in two steps:

1. **Gush** — set the timer and write. While it runs, Backspace and Delete are off. You cannot fix anything, so keep going. Stalled? Write that you stalled.
2. **Shape** — when the buzzer sounds, a composer opens beside your gush. Build your one page from the raw material. Export it as a PDF to hand in.

Readings

Load a chapter with **+ Load readings** (pick several at once) or **+ Load a folder**. Switch chapters from the dropdown. Read one page at a time, or flip to Continuous.

Currere

The four moments — Regressive, Progressive, Analytical, Synthetical. Same gush-then-shape rhythm, with the structure loosening as you go. Every one of them can be kept in your notebook, including the Analytical comparison.

Notebook

Your kept pages, seen four ways: **By day** (a calendar), **By piece** (one piece across the whole term, so you can watch it change), **My Progress** (what you are handing in, and where you stand), and **Threads** (what keeps coming back).

Keeping a page

Your drafts save themselves as you type. When a page is worth keeping, press **+ Add to notebook**. That dates it and files it in your Notebook.

Come back to it. Open the same piece weeks later, write more, and add to notebook again. Both passes stay, dated, so your thinking shows over time.

The four required entries

Four entries are required for the notebook's **Required entries** row: your Week 1 **Why do we write?** baseline, your **currere** gushes and brainstorms, your **Topic map**, and your **Source notes**. Three of them have their own page under **Freewrite** → **For the notebook** — keeping the page tags it — and the currere is tagged from any of your gushes. The **Look-Back Letter** is *not* one of the four: it has its own row and its own 10 points, and its own page under the same menu.

The Letter writes back. Open the Look-Back Letter and your Week 1 answer is sitting beside it, so you can see what you said in August while you answer it in December.

Your readings count

Commenting on a reading **is** an entry — there is nothing to write up afterwards. Mark what is worth keeping, write what you make of it, and at **three comments** the reading counts as one entry toward Kept practice. One reading is one entry however many comments it holds, and every comment keeps its own date.

Where you stand.  **My Progress** lists every reading of the course, grouped Romano · Currere · Articles, with a green ✓ on the ones that count. On the **Readings** shelf the same groups appear with the same ticks. If a file lands in the wrong group — its name was not one Journaler could read — use the  beside it, or  **Match readings** to fix several at once.

Turning it in

You do not hand in the whole notebook. You hand in a **report** — the pages you chose, and what you made of them. Everything else is counted, not read.

- Press  **My Progress** in the top bar. The panel at the top shows the four scored rows and where you stand on each.
- Before you submit, **flag three entries** you want read closely — one from each act of the course.
- Write your reading of one **thread** — something that kept coming back across several entries.
- Press **Bundle notebook** → **PDF**. That is what you turn in.

Most of it counts without being read. A flagged or required entry is printed in full. Everything else appears as one line in the Contents — numbered, dated, with its word count. That is what keeps the report short and the rest of your notebook genuinely unjudged.

Saving & moving your work

-  **Save my work** (top bar) downloads one file with everything you have written.
- Put that file wherever you keep things — Google Drive, Dropbox, or a thumb drive.
- On any computer, open Journaler and use  **Open my file** to pick up where you left off.

Do this often. Your work is saved in this browser, but a lab computer can be wiped. The saved file is your real backup.

The AI partner (optional)

Connect a model with the **AI** button, top right. After a gush, a reflection partner asks how the writing *felt* — it never touches your words. Journaler works fully without AI, too.